

What is the ReOps project?

The ReOps project is a team effort to make research easier to plan, run, document, find, reuse, and scale across Rover. The goal is not to add more processes for the sake of processes. The goal is to fix the main operational pain points identified in the audit and create lightweight standards that help researchers work more consistently and efficiently. This includes improving how we recruit participants, manage incentives, document research, use AI safely, handle data and privacy, and make past research easier to find and reuse.

Vision

 Enabling every team at Rover to make faster, more confident decisions through consistent, scalable research operations.

Mission

 Our mission is to improve the way we organize, document, and reuse research through small, practical, and sustainable ResearchOps improvements.

Timeline for this year

Timeline	Focus	What we will do
Q2	Align on priorities	Use the audit to agree on the most important ReOps milestones and classify them by priority.
Q3 - Q4	Quick ReOps Fixes	Start with small, practical improvements such as naming conventions, intake improvements, sample design guidance, recruitment templates, and documentation basics.

Q4 TBD	AI, data, and quality standards	Create lightweight guidance for AI use in research, data processing, synthesis, reporting, privacy reminders, and human review.
Q4 TBD	Bigger operational blockers	Start scoping larger fixes that need cross-functional support, such as recruitment access, incentive workflows, privacy processes, and repository foundations.
End of year TBD	Consolidate and scale	Review what worked, document approved practices, identify remaining gaps, and define the next phase of ReOps work.

How researchers can contribute

Contribution	Example
Identify pain points	Share where current research workflows are slow, unclear, risky, or inconsistent.
Propose Quick ReOps Fixes	Suggest small improvements such as templates, checklists, naming rules, or documentation standards.
Build resources	Help create sample guides, AI validation checklists, report templates, recruitment guides, or research wrap-up checklists.
Test and improve	Try new templates or workflows in real projects and give feedback.
Share existing practices	Document workflows that already work well so others can reuse them.
Support adoption	Help make ReOps practices easy enough that people actually use them, a radical concept.

Fix typology

Type	Meaning
 Quick ReOps Fix	Small, async, low-effort, can be aligned and implemented quickly
 Template/Guideline	Needs documentation, standards, examples, or checklists
 Tool/Automation	Needs software access, automation, or system changes
 Cross-project	Needs Legal, Data, Finance, Product, Ops, or Engineering
 Keep as is	Working well, no immediate ReOps intervention needed

ReOps Milestones Organized by Priority

Priority Definition

Priority	What it means
P0	Fix first. Blocking, risky, legally sensitive, or causing major operational pain.
P1	High priority. Not always blocking, but important for quality, consistency, AI safety, or future scalability
P2	Medium priority. Mostly working, but needs better templates, checklists, or clearer standards
P3	Low priority. Working well. Keep it light and avoid unnecessary processes.

Milestones

Priority	Milestone	What is this about
P0	Recruitment & Participants	Researchers rely on other teams to retrieve participant data and send invitations, causing delays. Tasks like sample extraction, audience definition, and quantitative invitations are top operational priorities.
P0	Incentives	Incentive management is highly manual, error-prone, and operationally risky. Bulk payments, individual wallet deposits, tracking, and payment reconciliation are major pain points.
P0	Data & Privacy	This is a hidden legal and compliance risk. Researchers may skip AI usage consent, EU data consent, or privacy steps because the rules are confusing, unclear, or not consistently embedded in the research workflow.
P1	Repository	Researchers search for prior work, but many skip uploading summaries, tags, metadata, and links to related studies because there is no clear process or tool. This creates long-term knowledge loss and makes research harder to reuse.
P1	Analysis & Synthesis	This is one of the highest-effort phases. Researchers use AI to read, process, and synthesize data, but there is no standard process to prevent hallucinations, weak interpretations, or unsupported insights.
P1	Data Processing / Raw Data	Tasks such as transcription, cleaning, anonymization, and structuring notes take a lot of time. AI is already used to speed up this phase, but the team needs clearer standards for quality, privacy, and human review.
P1	Research Intake,	The process for accepting and prioritizing new requests is not standardized. Even if an intake

	Roadmap & Prioritization	template exists, it is not consistently used. The team needs to understand why and clarify how requests move from intake to prioritization to roadmap decisions.
P2	Reporting	Researchers consistently produce reports and sometimes use AI as a writing assistant. The opportunity is to standardize report structure, executive summaries, evidence requirements, limitations, and recommendations.
P2	Data Retention & Deletion	Researchers frequently skip deleting old recordings or controlling access because the process is unclear. This needs clearer retention rules, project closure steps, and access review expectations.
P2	Fieldwork	Interviews and usability sessions require significant effort but are conducted consistently. The main friction points are scheduling, reminders, no-shows, rescheduling, preparation, and participant communication.
P3	Instrument Development	The team consistently and safely designs surveys and discussion guides. This works well and requires research training. ReOps should support with optional checklists and examples, not over-standardize the craft.
P3	Planning & Design	Researchers own this phase and generally avoid using AI because it requires strategic thinking and contextual judgment. ReOps should not standardize methodology choice, but can support sample design, budget estimation, timelines, and agency scoping.
P3	Shareout & Activation	Presenting insights to stakeholders happens consistently and safely. This does not require major intervention, but could benefit from light

templates for decisions, next steps, async sharing, and research activation.

Proposed actions by milestone

1. Research Intake & Prioritization P2

Action	Type	Quick ReOps Fix?	Responsible	Link
☐ Audit the current intake process and identify why it is not being used	Process review	NO		
☐ Map current request entry points, such as Slack, meetings, roadmap reviews, direct messages, and planning docs	Process review	YES		
☐ Intake: Define the minimum required information for a research request	Template	MAYBE		
☒ Intake: Simplify the intake form if it is too long, unclear, or disconnected from real workflows	Quick ReOps Fix	MAYBE		
☐ Create a "what makes a good research request" guide for stakeholders	Template	MAYBE		
☐ Create simple prioritization criteria based on business impact, decision urgency, user risk, confidence gap, and team capacity	Process review Template	NO		
☐ Create a monthly or quarterly research roadmap review process w/pods	Process review	NO		
☐ Align w/ Product, Design, and Marketing on how research requests should be submitted and prioritized	Cross-functional alignment	NO		
☐ Share the official research roadmap. To make it visible to stakeholders	Process review	YES		

2. Planning & Design P3

Action	Type	Quick ReOps Fix?	Responsible	Link
☐ Sample design guide by method	Process review	NO		
☐ Sample design checklist	Template/ Guideline	YES		
☐ Sample size ranges by study type	Template/ Guideline	YES		
☐ Agency brief template	Template/ Guideline	YES		
☐ Budget estimation template	Template/ Guideline	YES		
☐ Timeline estimator by method	Template/ Guideline	YES		
☐ Agency budget request guide	Process guideline	YES		
☐ Formal agency approval workflow	Cross functional process	YES		
☐ Methodology decision tree	Template/ Guideline	MAYBE		

3. Recruitment & Participants P0

Action	Type	Quick ReOps Fix?	Responsible	Link
☐ Create a Mode query guide for Owners, including tables, variables, filters, and sample queries.	Template/ Guideline	YES		
☐ Create a Mode query guide for Providers that includes activity, booking history, services, and quality filters.	Template/ Guideline	YES		
☐ Create a recruitment variable dictionary for	Template/ Guideline	YES		

Owners and Providers with definitions, source tables, and use cases.				
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☐ Create a sample request brief template for requesting participant samples from Data / Analytics.	Cross functional process	YES		
☐ Create a recruitment decision guide to determine when to use internal databases, external panels, agencies, or tools such as UserTesting.	Template/ Guideline	YES		
☐ Create a screening-criteria checklist covering inclusion and exclusion criteria, quotas, and recruitment requirements.	Template/ Guideline	YES		
☐ Create sample size guidance by research method.	Template/ Guideline	YES		
☐ Create a participant source tracker to document recruitment sources, criteria, and response metrics.	Template/ Guideline	YES		
☐ Create a standard invitation brief for quantitative studies.	Template/ Guideline	YES		
☐ Create reusable recruitment email and invitation templates for different study types.	Template/ Guideline	YES		
☐ Create a recruitment quality checklist to validate sample quality, duplicates, eligibility, and exclusions.	Template/ Guideline	YES		
☐ Create a participant privacy checklist covering PII, consent, and data retention requirements.	Template/ Guideline	NO		
☐ Define recruitment SLAs for participant sample extraction requests.	Process review	NO		
☐ Provide direct researcher access to approved Mode queries or dashboards.	Tools	NO		
☐ Implement automated sample extraction workflows	Tools	NO		

for recurring recruitment scenarios.				
☐ Implement a scalable process for automated quantitative study invitations.	Tools	NO		

4. Incentives PO

Action	Type	Quick ReOps Fix?	Responsible	Link
Create an incentive strategy guide by study type, market, participant profile, and study effort.	Template/ Guideline	YES		
Create an incentive tracker template to monitor participant status, payment amount, payment method, and payment completion.	Template/ Guideline	YES		
Define standard incentive approval requirements, including when budget owner approval is needed.	Template/ Guideline	YES		
Create a post-study incentive	Template/ Guideline	YES		

reconciliation checklist to verify who was paid and resolve missing payments.				
Document the current manual incentive process for wallet deposits, bulk payments, Tremendous, Tango, or other tools.	Template/ Guideline	YES		
Define ownership for each incentive step, including researcher, Finance, Payments, and external vendors.	Cross functional process	NO		
Standardize the bulk incentive payment process.	Cross functional process	NO		
Provide researchers with direct access to approved incentive tools where appropriate.	Cross functional process	NO		
Implement automated bulk incentive payment workflows.	Cross functional process	NO		
Create a centralized incentive log for auditability and operational visibility.	Tools	NO		

5. Instrument Development P3

Action	Type	Quick ReOps Fix?	Responsible	Link
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Create a survey-quality checklist covering question wording, logic, routing, scales, and response options.	Template/ Guideline	NO		
Create a discussion-guide-quality checklist covering flow, neutrality, probes, timing, and alignment with the research objective.	Template/ Guideline	NO		
Create a peer review checklist for surveys and discussion guides before launch.	Template/ Guideline	YES		
Define when instrument review is required, optional, or not needed.	Template/ Guideline	YES		
Create guidance for adapting instruments across markets and languages.	Template/ Guideline	YES		

Create AI usage guidance for drafting or refining research instruments.	Template/ Guideline	YES		
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6. Fieldwork P2

Action	Type	Quick ReOps Fix?	Responsible	Link
Create scheduling message templates for interviews, usability sessions, and diary study follow-ups.	Template/ Guideline	YES		
Create no-show and rescheduling message templates.	Template/ Guideline	YES		
Create a moderation checklist for interviews and usability sessions.	Template/ Guideline	YES		
Create a participant communication checklist for confirmations, reminders, and follow-ups.	Template/ Guideline	YES		
Create a session note-taking template for	Template/ Guideline	YES		

observers and researchers.				
Create a fieldwork issue tracker to document no-shows, technical issues, participant quality problems, and rescheduling.	Template/ Guideline	YES		
Implement calendar scheduling automation for research sessions.	Cross-functional process	NO		

7. Data Processing P1

Action	Type	Quick ReOps Fix?	Responsible	Link
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Create transcript naming rules for all qualitative studies.	Template/ Guideline	Yes		
Create transcript cleanup guidelines, including what can be edited and what should remain unchanged.	Template/ Guideline	Yes		
Create a processed data folder structure for transcripts, notes, survey exports, cleaned files, and analysis outputs.	Template/ Guideline	Yes		
Create an anonymization checklist for transcripts, notes, recordings, and open-text responses.	Template/ Guideline	Yes		
Create AI usage guidance for transcription, note structuring, and transcript cleanup.	Template/ Guideline	Yes		
Create a human review checklist for AI-generated transcripts or summaries.	Template/ Guideline	Yes		
Create basic naming	Template/ Guideline	Yes		

conventions for raw data, cleaned data, and analysis outputs.				
Define quality checks for survey data cleaning, including duplicates, speeders, straightliners, and incomplete responses.	Template/ Guideline	Yes		

8. Analysis & Synthesis P1

Action	Type	Quick ReOps Fix?	Responsible	Link
Create an AI validation checklist for analysis and synthesis.	Template/ Guideline	YES		
☒ Create a guide on the differences among evidence, findings, insights, and recommendations and build structure	Template/ Guideline	YES	@Soledad Strunc	Insight Standardization
Create examples of strong vs weak insights.	Template/ Guideline	YES		
Define when AI can support synthesis and when it should not be used.	Template/ Guideline	YES		

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9. Reporting P2

Action	Type	Quick ReOps Fix?	Responsible	Link
Create a standard research report structure.	Template/ Guideline	YES		
Create an executive summary template for research reports.	Template/ Guideline	YES		
Create report structure examples by study type, such as usability, foundational, survey, concept test, or benchmark.	Template/ Guideline	YES		
Create an evidence requirements checklist for claims in reports.	Template/ Guideline	YES		
Create a final report QA checklist covering clarity, evidence, recommendations, limitations, and next steps.	Template/ Guideline	YES		
Create a recommendation framing guide to help	Template/ Guideline	YES		

connect findings to product, marketing, or strategic decisions.				
Create a standard appendix structure for methodology, sample, screener, and materials.	Template/ Guideline	YES		
Create automated report generation from structured data or templates.	Automation/Tool			

10. Shareout & Activation P3

Action	Type	Quick ReOps Fix?	Responsible	Link
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Create a stakeholder readout checklist.	Template/ Guideline	Yes		
Create a readout deck structure for common study types	Template/ Guideline	Yes		
Create a stakeholder follow-up message template after research readouts	Template/ Guideline	Yes		
Create a decision and next steps section for every report or readout.	Template/ Guideline	Yes		
Create a research activation checklist to capture actions, owners, decisions, and open questions.	Template/ Guideline	Yes		
Create a decision log template linked to each research project.	Template/ Guideline	Yes		
Create guidance on when a readout is needed vs when async sharing is enough.	Template/ Guideline	Yes		
Create a template for sharing research summaries in Slack or Confluence.	Template/ Guideline	Yes		
Create a mechanism	Process review	No		

to track whether research influenced the roadmap, design, messaging, or strategy.				
Integrate research decisions into Jira, roadmap tools, or planning workflows.	Cross-functional process	No		

11. Data Retention & Deletion P2

Action	Type	Quick ReOps Fix?	Responsible	Link
Add data retention steps to the research wrap-up checklist.	Template/ Guideline			
Create a Drive access review checklist for research folders.	Template/ Guideline			
Create a data retention decision guide by data type, such as recordings, transcripts, notes, survey exports, and screenshots.	Template/ Guideline			
Create a simple project closure checklist covering storage, deletion,	Template/ Guideline			

access, and ownership.				
Define who owns data deletion after project completion.	Process review			
Define standard timelines for deleting recordings and sensitive research materials.	Template/ Guideline			
Create a reminder system for recording deletion and access review.	Process review			
Implement automated access reviews for research folders.	Process review			
Implement automated retention or deletion workflows for research data.	Process review			

12. Data & Privacy PO

Action	Type	Quick ReOps Fix?	Responsible	Link
Create a “when to ask Legal” checklist for research projects.	Process review			
Create a privacy checklist for	Template/ Guideline			

research planning, including PII, consent, recording, AI usage, and data access.				
Create a simple matrix of what data can and cannot be uploaded to AI tools.	Template/ Guideline	No		
Create EU data privacy guidance for research projects.	Template/ Guideline	No		
Standardize AI usage consent language for research participants.	Template/ Guideline	No		
Standardize regional consent templates for key markets.	Template/ Guideline	No		
Define access control rules for research files containing participant data.	Template/ Guideline	No		
Define escalation process for sensitive research, vulnerable participants, or high-risk data.	Template/ Guideline	No		
Create privacy training for	Process review	No		

researchers working with AI tools.				
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13. Repository P1

Action	Type	Quick ReOps Fix?	Responsible	Link
Standardize research project names.	Template/ Guideline			
Create a standard Confluence title format for research pages.	Template/ Guideline		@Lizeth Herrera	Link
Create a standard Confluence project page template.	Template/ Guideline			
Define required metadata fields for research projects.	Template/ Guideline			
Create a standard evidence folder structure.	Template/ Guideline			
Create a research summary template for repository-ready documentation.	Template			
Create a simple tagging taxonomy for market, segment, method, research type,	Template/ Guideline			

product area, and topic.				
Create guidance on what should be stored in Confluence vs Drive vs research tools.	Template/ Guideline	Yes		
Create a repository maintenance checklist for project closure.	Template/ Guideline	Yes		
Create a process for linking findings, insights, recommendations, and decisions.	Process Review	No		
Audit existing Confluence research pages and identify missing metadata, summaries, and broken links.	Process Review	No		
Build a full research repository.	Tool	No		
Implement AI-powered research retrieval across existing studies.	Tool	No		